

Diwali Money Cheat Sheet

Khushiyan poori, kharcha control mein. One page for the whole festival · Paisa Samjho Raj

1. Fix the Diwali cap first

Before any shopping, write ONE number for the whole festival: gifts, sweets, clothes, lights, pooja, travel. Pay from this cap, never from the Future (savings) jar.

2. Split the cap (example: ₹20,000)

Bucket	Share	₹
Gifts + sweets	35%	7,000
Clothes	25%	5,000
Home, lights, pooja	20%	4,000
Travel	10%	2,000
Buffer	10%	2,000

3. Next Diwali, no shock

Diwali comes on a date we already know. Spread it over the year:

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This year's cost ÷ 12 = save every month
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₹24,000 ÷ 12 = **₹2,000 a month** in a separate "Diwali jar" from next month.

4. Sale check before you tap "Buy"

- Need, want or just pressure? (Ask honestly.)
- Big item? Sleep on it for 24 hours.
- Compare the final price with delivery, fees and taxes, not the "MRP cut".
- Is it inside the cap? If not, something else goes out.

5. "No-cost EMI" check

- Is there a processing fee?
- Is GST charged on the interest part?
- Do you lose a cash or card discount by choosing EMI?
- Add it all up: total paid vs the cash price.

6. Credit card: pay the full bill

"Minimum due" only stops the late fee. Interest runs on everything you leave unpaid, at up to about **3.75% a month (45% a year)**. Shopping on the card? Keep that amount aside the same day.

7. Festival fraud: 5 rules

- You never enter your UPI PIN to **receive** money. A "collect request" asks you to pay.
- "You won a Diwali gift / lucky draw" by SMS or WhatsApp: delete it. Don't click the link.
- Never share an OTP, PIN or password, even with someone who says they are from the bank or the police.
- Check the website address before paying; big discounts on fake sites are the bait.
- Lost money? Call **1930** (national cyber fraud helpline) at once, tell your bank and report on **cybercrime.gov.in**.

8. Five-minute check after Diwali

Write down what you really spent in each bucket. Over the cap? Note where, and set next year's monthly Diwali jar (step 3) today. Chhota-chhota daalo, bada-bada banao!

Want the whole family plan?

Raj's book **Paisa Samjho: Salary se Savings tak** follows the Verma family through 20 chapters: yearly costs like Diwali (chapter 4), credit cards, no-cost EMI and UPI fraud, with worked rupee examples. Free sample and the book: **paisasamjhoraj.com/#shop**